

FAMOUS PHARAOKHS

The kings and queens of Ancient Egypt did not call themselves pharaohs, but that is the name we use today. They wielded an enormous amount of power. They made every law, held the title of highest priest in the land, and were worshipped as though they were gods.



KHUFU
Reigned c.2589–2566 BCE
Builder of the Great Pyramid at Giza.



KHAFRA
Reigned c.2558–2532 BCE
Khufu's son. His face may be the model for the Sphinx.



HATSHEPSUT
Reigned c.1473–1458 BCE
One of only a few female pharaohs.

TUTANKHAMUN
Reigned c.1336–1327 BCE
The famous boy-king came to the throne when he was just nine years old. His fabulous gold mask was found in his tomb.



TUTHMOSIS III
Reigned c.1479–1425 BCE
Great military leader who never lost a battle.



AMENHOTEP III
Reigned c.1390–1353 BCE
Helped to make Egypt prosperous.



AKHENATEN
Reigned c.1353–1336 BCE
Rejected traditional Egyptian gods.



RAMESES II
Reigned c.1279–1213 BCE
Ordered many huge building projects.



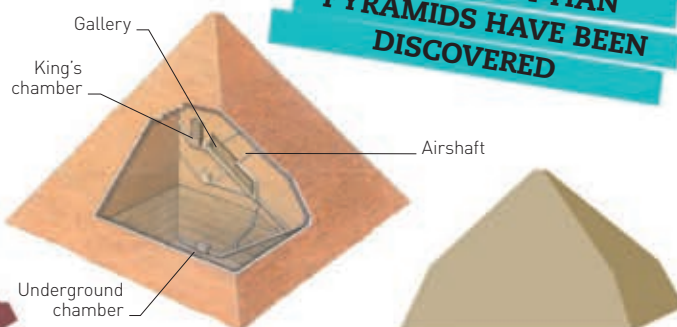
CLEOPATRA VII
Reigned 51–30 BCE
Last pharaoh. Killed herself after defeat by Rome.

Ancient Egypt

More than 5,000 years ago, two regions of the Nile river valley – Upper and Lower Egypt – were united under a common ruler. This was the birth of the empire of pharaohs and pyramids, one of the greatest powers of the ancient world.

PYRAMIDS

When an Egyptian ruler died the body was buried inside a massive pyramid. Taking up to 30 years to build, pyramids went through various changes of design over the centuries. People who were not royal were buried in simpler tombs.



**MORE THAN 90
ANCIENT EGYPTIAN
PYRAMIDS HAVE BEEN
DISCOVERED**

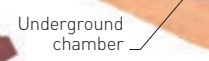
MASTABA

Box-like brick or stone grave.



STEPPED PYRAMID

An early model, built in layers.



SMOOTH-SIDED PYRAMID

The classic structure, cased with blocks of limestone.



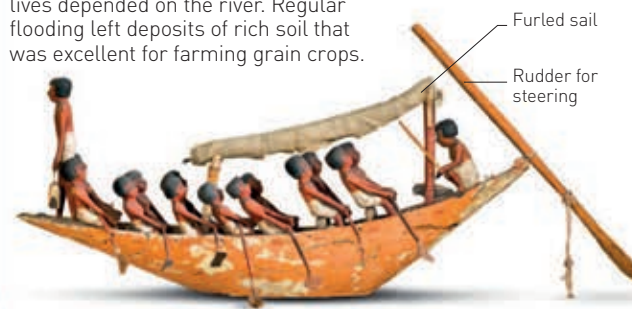
"BENT" PYRAMID

Midway between stepped and smooth.

THE RIVER NILE

Living along both banks of the Nile, the Egyptians occupied a rare fertile strip of land amid vast areas of desert. Their lives depended on the river. Regular flooding left deposits of rich soil that was excellent for farming grain crops.

ROWING BOAT
Wooden boats were used for transport and fishing.



MUMMY-MAKING

The Ancient Egyptians believed that a dead person's soul needed its body in the afterlife. Mummifying – which only the rich could afford – was an elaborate way of preserving a body to stop it crumbling away.



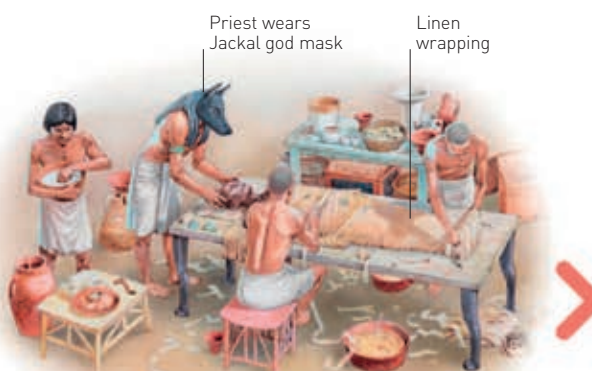
1 PRESERVING
After removal, the organs were preserved in canopic jars – pots topped with a god's head.



2 WASHING
Once dry, the body was washed in wine and rubbed with scents and oils.



3 PROTECTING
Protective amulets, like this symbolic pillar, were placed with the body.



4 WRAPPING
Strips of fine linen were wrapped around the entire body and coated with resin.



5 BURIAL
The mummy was put in an inner, body-shaped case and then an outer coffin, both decorated with pictures and symbols.